Lingua inglese

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ARTICLES

1.The indefinite article: **a/an**

2.The definite article: **the**

3.Zero article: **Ø**

The indefinite article: a/an

We use *a/an* – the indefinite article – when we talk about something for the first time, or something that is part of a group or type.

- before unspecified singular countable nouns

She works in **an** office.

- with the names of professions

He's **a** manager.

The indefinite article: a/an

- in expressions of measurements

It sells at €1.75 **a** litre.

- before a noun to mean all things of the same type

A boutique hotel is **a** small, stylish and fashionable hotel that is not part of **a** chain.

The indefinite article: a/an

We use **a** when the word that follows it begins with a consonant sound. We use **an** when it's followed by a vowel sound. This makes pronunciation easier.

She has **a** university degree.

It took me **an** hour to get home.

The definite article: the

We use **the** – the definite article – when the listener already knows which thing we are talking about because it was mentioned before or because there's only one of them.

I'm going to take **the** dog for a walk.

Have you seen **the** car key?

They go to the school next to **the** bridge.

The definite article: the

- it is clear from the context what particular thing or place is meant

I'll meet you in **the** reception area.

- before a noun that we have mentioned before

They had a villa in Cannes and a chalet in Innsbruck, but they sold **the** villa.

- before adjectives to specify a category of people or things

the rich, **the** poor, **the** French, **the** unemployed, **the** World Wide Web

Zero article

When we talk about things in general, we normally use a plural or uncountable noun with no article.

Birds eat worms.
Water freezes at 0°C.
Children need a lot of sleep.

- mass nouns used in general statements

(Ø) Money is the root of all (Ø) evil.

- the names of places and people

(Ø) Italy, (Ø) Japan, (Ø) President Biden

POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVES, POSSESSIVE AND REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS

1. Possessive adjectives

2. Possessive pronouns

3. Reflexive pronouns

POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVES, POSSESSIVE AND REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS

Subject pronouns	Possessive adjectives	Possessive pronouns
I	my	mine
you	your	yours
he	his	his
she	her	hers
it	its	---
we	our	ours
they	their	theirs

Possessive adjectives

The **possessive adjectives** in English (also called 'possessive determiners') are: my, your, his, her, its, our and their. They say who something belongs to.

I have a house - this is **my** house.
You have a son - that is **your** son.
He has a bicycle - it is **his** bicycle.
She has a flat - it is **her** flat.
The dog has a toy – it is **its** toy.
We have a computer - it is **our** computer.
They have a car - it is **their** car.

Possessive pronouns

Possessive pronouns also say who something belongs to, but they replace the noun. So we use them alone. In this case, we don’t use its. In English, the possessive pronouns are: mine, yours, his, hers, ours and theirs.

I have a house - this is **mine**.

You have a cat - it is **yours**.

He has a bicycle - it is **his**.

She has a flat - it is **hers**.

We have a computer - it is **ours**.

They have a car - it is **theirs**.

Reflexive pronouns

A **reflexive pronoun** is a pronoun that is used in the object position when the subject and the object of the sentence are the same.

Reflexive pronouns end in -self or -selves depending on whether they are singular or plural. All personal pronouns, including the impersonal pronoun “one”, have a reflexive form.

Reflexive pronouns

Yesterday I hurt **myself** really badly.

You should introduce **yourself** to our new colleague.

She is looking at **herself** in the mirror.

The children enjoyed **themselves** at the birthday party.

It is important to trust **oneself**.

Reflexive pronouns

Subject pronouns	Reflexive pronouns
I	myself
you	yourself
he	himself
she	herself
it	itself
we	ourselves
you	yourselves
they	themselves
one	oneself

THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION!

ARTICLES

Fill in the gaps with: THE, A, AN or --- (no article)

1. _____ boys like playing with cars.
2. _____ Amazon is South America's largest river.
3. What _____ amazing idea he had yesterday evening.
4. My dad always liked to go to _____ school.
5. Did you see the film on _____ television or at _____ cinema?
6. _____ Uncle Norman and _____ Aunt Lydia stayed with us over the weekend.
7. Austria was ruled by _____ Habsburgs for many centuries.
8. Dad told us to go to _____ bed at ten.
9. I met _____ few American tourists when I was in Italy.
10. _____ Soviet Union was _____ first country to send _____ human being into _____ space.
11. I had to stay in _____ hospital for two weeks in order to recover.
12. _____ oranges and apples have a lot of vitamins.
13. This is _____ most wonderful present I've ever had.
14. I'm not very hungry. I had _____ big breakfast
15. Peter lives in Tokyo, _____ capital of Japan.

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KEY

1. --- boys like playing with cars.
2. The Amazon is South America's largest river.
3. What an amazing idea he had yesterday evening.
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POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVES, PRONOUNS

Task 1

Choose the correct alternative.

1) Peter's hair is black. *My* / *Mine* is brown.
2) *Their* / *Theirs* car is huge.
3) This is my toothbrush, not *your* / *yours*.
4) She rides *her* / *hers* bicycle every afternoon.
5) This is *our* / *ours* new office. Do you like it?
6) The cat likes playing with *its* / *hers* new toy.
7) They live in a beautiful house. However, it's not *their* / *theirs*.
8) *Your* / *Yours* mother is very kind.

Task 2

Fill in the gaps with the suitable reflexive pronoun.

1) He introduced _____ to her family.
2) They should be able to look after _____ at their age.
3) I'm trying to teach _____ French.
4) Do you talk to _____ sometimes?
5) She enjoyed _____ at the reception.
6) If we are smart, we can help _____ .

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KEY

Task 1

1) Mine
2) Their
3) yours
4) her
5) our
6) its
7) theirs
8) Your

Task 2

1) himself
2) themselves
3) myself
4) yourself
5) herself
6) ourselves

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